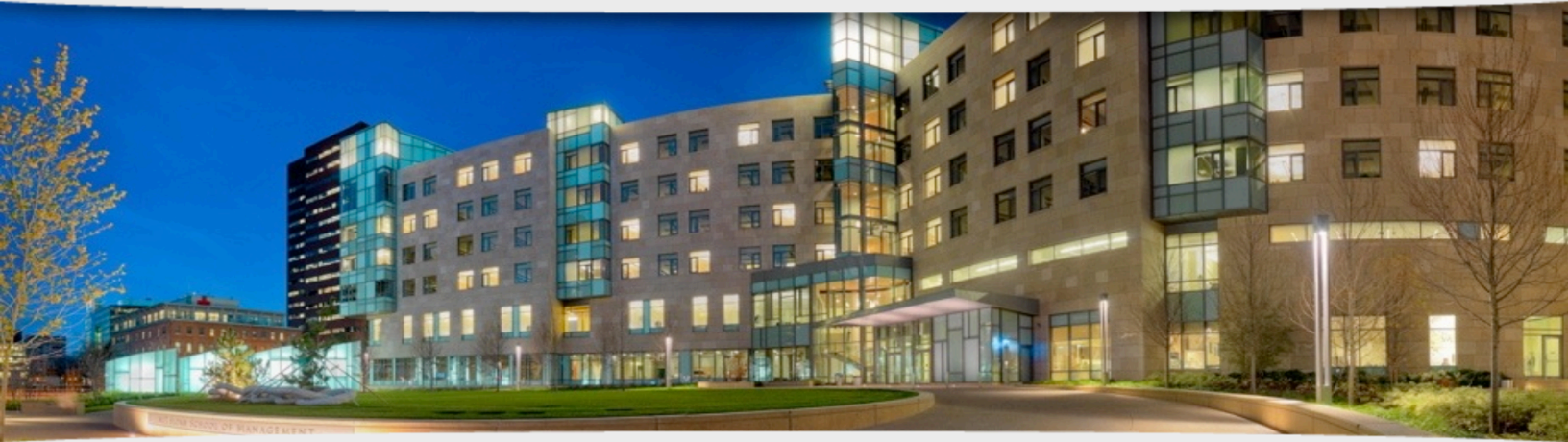




FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
MIT SLOAN

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO MIT SLOAN

ABOUT THE SCHOOL

MIT Sloan has a very different feel from its neighbor across the Charles River – the campus is more urban and industrial, with an informal mish-mash of architectural styles and a few green spaces. The Sloan School, unlike Harvard, does not have its own library, but rather shares it with the university. So there are more opportunities to mix with students from the rest of MIT.

Several well-known financial and managerial theories were developed through MIT Sloan. There is a strong analytical and data-driven focus here, especially in the core classes, and this is combined with an emphasis on innovation. Students only take one semester of core classes so there is a lot of flexibility to focus on electives. The smaller size of the student body means that the collaborative and energetic culture of innovation counts for a lot.

MIT Sloan is about invention and "ideas that are made to matter." Notable companies founded by MIT Sloan alumni include: E*Trade, Gartner, Genentech, HubSpot, InVivo Therapeutics, Teradyne, and Zipcar.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Known for its emphasis on innovation, technology, and entrepreneurship. The school is also very strong in production/operations, finance, big data, energy, manufacturing, information systems and health care.

INCOMING CLASS

Number of Applicants: 5,560
Admissions Selectivity: 11.5%
Total Tuition: \$148,400

MBA Class Size: 409
Yield: 60.68%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Consulting 31.6%; Tech 29.4%, Finance 16.4%, Starting a Business 9.7%;

Top Recruiters: Amazon, McKinsey, BCG, Bain, Deloitte, Microsoft, Facebook, Anheuser-Busch

Avg. Base Salary: \$128,301

Employment within 3 months: 97%

MBA RANKINGS

	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek		9	9	14	4	7	3	7
Financial Times	5	5	5	5	7	7	6	8
Forbes	-	12	-	9	-	8	-	8
The Economist		7	9	10	12	12	15	14
US News	4	4	5	5	5	4	5	3

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Work Exp.: 4.9 yrs
Int'l Students: 38%

Avg. GMAT: 728
Women: 42%

Avg. GPA: 3.48

Deadlines for 2019-2020:

R1- Oct. 1, '19

R2- Jan 21, '20

R3 - Apr 9, '20

COVID-19 Changes to Admissions

As of March 24, 2020, the timeline for MBA Early Admission applications is extended, with a new deadline of June 2. MIT Sloan Early Admissions also accepts apps without exams, and only one letter of recommendation (plus two references who may be called). Applicants invited to interview will be notified in mid-June and all interviews will be conducted via Skype. Any offer of acceptance will be conditional.

Sources: MIT Sloan, BusinessWeek, Financial Times, US News, MBA50

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO MIT SLOAN

Breaking Down the MIT Sloan Application: Your Step by Step Strategy

By Brittany Maschal

Brittany a Fortuna Admissions Expert Coach and a former member of admissions teams at Wharton, Princeton & Johns Hopkins.

The MBA application for MIT Sloan – embodying the institution’s innovation ethos – eschews the conventions of its M7 peers. It’s a beast of an application, and successfully tackling it requires a different strategy than any other business school.

The standard fare for most top business schools include the application data, a standard one-page resume, essays and letters of recommendation (typically two). By contrast, MIT Sloan doesn’t require written essays, nor will it let you get away with recycling your standard MBA resume. Instead, you’ll be asked to create and capture several materials that no other school asks for.

Unique or uncommon to MIT Sloan:

- Cover letter
- One-minute video introduction
- Uniquely formatted resume
- One letter of recommendation, with contacts for two supporting recommenders
- Organizational chart
- Pre-interview reflection

MIT’s application process is a puzzle, and your challenge – and opportunity – is three-fold:

1. Convey a deep understanding of MIT’s core values and your fit for the program (self- and situational-awareness).
2. Demonstrate your unique value add, which needs to be both resume-specific and personal (your personal characteristics, traits, values and a sprinkle of more self-awareness).
3. Use your limited real estate to build a coherent narrative for your candidacy, and, while doing so, make sure you’re not repeating yourself. (This juggle across the various components of the application is the hardest part for many applicants; you need to do an excellent job of spreading the love on this app. Otherwise, it will fall flat.)

As a coach with Fortuna Admissions, and a former member of admissions teams at Wharton, Princeton, and Johns Hopkins, I’ve honed a methodology for tackling unique applications that require applicants to think and present information about themselves in new ways. I’ve applied this to the Sloan application and my work supporting many successful MIT Sloan candidates. You’ll find my best thinking on what works in the advice below.

First, tackle the less strategic components of the application first:

- The online application data
- The org chart
- The resume as per Sloan’s requirements

Start with a high-level review of what you can present in the application data, org chart, and resume and identify what you convey to the committee across these elements. There’s not much wiggle room for creativity or storytelling, so I suggest completing them, taking note of the traits and accomplishments you’ve conveyed, and move on!

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO MIT SLOAN

(For insights on navigating the org chart requirement, view this article on [Navigating the New Org Chart Requirement](#) by my Fortuna colleague, Heidi Hillis.)

The following parts of the Sloan application require more time and attention. This flow may not be intuitive, but it's extremely effective in terms of strategy.

First, the video introduction. This may not be where most people start but hear me out: Some stories are best told live and or can't be conveyed in 200 written words. Certain stories work here and won't in the cover letter. Start with the video in mind and brainstorm ideas best suited to the medium. Aim to go off resume by sharing a personal story that sparks real resonance in the viewer.

As detailed in my article on [how to Ace the Video Statement for MIT Sloan](#), take a risk to be vulnerable – the objective is to offer a genuine glimpse of who you are. You only have 60 seconds to deliver a response that's memorable, meaningful, and coherent. A powerful approach is to elaborate on one, specific experience that illuminates an important part of who you are. Everyone has stories to tell. Are you the only one in your family who can get your grandfather to talk about his health? Or is your crooked smile so infectious that you're known around your neighborhood for lighting up other's days? Don't be afraid to tell those stories.

Next, the cover letter. How do you act in line with MIT Sloan's values? Remember, MIT values individuals who act to make a difference, and you can often best demonstrate that you understand these values through work or extracurricular experiences. After you show them how you've already started to live out these values, you should make clear why the MBA is vital to get where you want to go next (career goals). You can weave in a brief "why" MIT line if it's fitting, but they don't want to read anything regurgitated from their website – they know their own program.

Finally, the (pre) interview reflection. This prompt is about diversity, which means articulating what you uniquely bring to the table. Please take note of a central theme that extends across the entire application: MIT Sloan values individuality so don't be afraid to be unapologetically you. Like the video intro and the cover letter, your savvy deployment of illustrative examples is key. When have you worked to create or better a community that is welcoming, inclusive and increasingly diverse? Choose a single answer and tell that story. Summon your courage and authenticity, and as you also persuade – whether it's through your love of MotoGP or chess or charity work – show them you already have developed this capacity and then make clear where you hope to parlay it while at MIT. And, this bears repeating: save the "why" MIT for the actual interview or post-interview email follow-up, which is the best place to fill in gaps of this sort.

As illustrated by the application components themselves, MIT is far more interested to learn about how you think and act – how you came up with an innovative solution, navigated a difficult decision and what makes you memorable. While they clearly value quantitative skills, MIT Sloan also cares about the very human aspects of your personality, and the values, integrity and commitment with which you lead your life. Allow its unconventional prompts to fuel your creativity and avoid the temptation to make yourself fit the profile you think Sloan may want. Focus on where you can stand out – because no one is more qualified than you to tell your own unique and authentic story.

Additional insights and tips, compiled by my colleagues at Fortuna Admissions, appear on the following pages.

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO MIT SLOAN

Tip #1 - Preference for STEM background & high quant GMAT

MIT Sloan very openly favors applicants with very strong quantitative foundations and has a history of attracting (and admitting) students with science, technology, engineering and mathematics profiles – as well as those who have a record of achievement in economics. If you do not have this kind of academic background, you need to make sure your quant score on the GMAT is very strong. If you undertake quantitative work in your current or a past role, you might also speak to your letter of recommendation writers about highlighting this skillset.

Tip #2 - Action-oriented profiles

MIT Sloan is the school which pioneered action-learning – the Institute's motto of *mens et manus* (Latin for "mind and hand") also points to the philosophy that you need not only be intelligent, but you also need to show you can successfully execute your ideas. In your application – specifically in the cover letter and interview – you should focus on describing detailed examples of your actions, which have contributed to your success or the success of others in a substantive, concrete way.

Tip #3 - Making an impact

Making a positive impact matters. The Admissions Committee wants to know what you plan to do with your degree that will positively impact the world. Sloan is a seriously mission-driven institution, looking for similarly minded individuals who will ultimately live out their mission. Where possible within the application (this includes the interview phase), you should demonstrate how you view success through the lens of benefiting others, and the world, in some way.

Tip #4 - Feelings rather than function

Like many of the admissions offices at the top schools, MIT Sloan has a fairly small team to handle the many thousands of applications it receives each year. As such, they have read countless applications that provide details of the tasks, projects and responsibilities of consultants, software engineers and financiers and have a pretty good idea of what those roles involve. Beyond avoiding technical jargon, avoid devoting too much space in your application to the mechanics of your job, which provides very little insight into who you are as a person and what makes you tick. Sloan is far more interested in how you thought through a particular challenge or situation, devised an innovative solution, or navigated making a difficult decision. While they clearly value numbers and analytical skills, MIT Sloan is still trying to unearth the very human aspects of your personality, and the values, integrity and passion with which you lead your life.

Tip #5 - In pursuit of excellence

Sloan is interested in students who demonstrate excellence in terms of their work experience, academic achievements, and their goals. Make sure you highlight where you have outperformed or been an overachiever throughout your application in very measurable, concrete ways. Excellence need not only be in the professional sphere – if you are a karate black belt, master chess player, avid musician – make sure to weave that in to your application as well.

Tip #6 - Be authentic and distinct

In addition to excellence, the Admissions Committee is searching for authenticity – being able to explain what you want to do and why in a convincing and credible way is key to getting serious consideration. Avoid the temptation to make yourself fit a profile you think Sloan may want. You have your own unique and authentic story, so own it. Focus on where you may be able to best stand out – maybe where you've even taken a bit of a risk – to avoid blending into the masses.

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR APPLYING TO MIT SLOAN

Tip #7 - The relationship with MIT

Because of its emphasis on innovation, many of Sloan's alumni have made strides in terms of being entrepreneurs, particularly in the field of technology. If you have entrepreneurial ambitions, including how you plan to leverage the technical expertise of the larger MIT community, this will make you a more attractive applicant. But please, avoid rehashing what MIT already knows about themselves or regurgitating information about the program from off their website.

Don't forget, when it comes to attracting top talent Sloan goes head to head with Stanford and Haas from the west coast, and HBS just across the Charles River. If appropriate, articulate how the interaction with some of the world's brightest engineers and scientists, and an extraordinary ecosystem for startups matches with your MBA goals.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, LBS, Chicago Booth, Kellogg, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances for admission, reserve yours at: [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)